



PRIME'S CIMETIDINE 400 TABLET

Description: White, oval, biconvex tablet with P-P embossed on one side.

Contents: Each tablet contains cimetidine 400mg

Indications:

It is indicated in the treatment of active peptic ulcer, NSAID induced lesions, gastroesophageal reflux disease and Zollinger-Ellison syndrome.

Pharmacology:

Cimetidine is a histamine H₂-receptor antagonist. Accordingly, it inhibits gastric acid secretion and reduces pepsin output. It has also been shown to inhibit other actions of histamine mediated by H₂ receptors. It has a weak anti androgenic effects such as gynecomastia have occasionally occurred. Cimetidine is readily absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract after administration with food delaying the rate of absorption. Cimetidine is partially metabolised in the liver to sulfoxide and to hydroxymethylcimetidine. Most of the cimetidine is excreted unchanged. Cimetidine crosses the placental barrier and is excreted into breast milk.

Adverse Effects:

Adverse reactions to cimetidine are generally infrequent and are usually reversible following a reduction of dosage or withdrawal of therapy. The commonest side effect reported have been diarrhoea, dizziness, tiredness, headache and rashes. Reversible confusional states, esp. in the elderly or in seriously ill patients such as those with renal failure, have occasionally occurred. Cimetidine has a weak anti androgenic effect and gynecomastia and impotence have also occasionally occurred in men receiving relatively high doses for conditions such as Zollinger-Ellison syndrome. Other adverse effects which have been reported rarely are hypersensitivity reaction and fever, arthralgia, myalgia, blood disorders including agranulocytosis or neutropenia and thrombocytopenia, interstitial nephritis, hepatotoxicity and cardiovascular disorders.

Precautions:

Before giving cimetidine to patients with gastric ulcers, the possibility of malignancy should be excluded since cimetidine may mask symptoms and delay diagnosis. It should be given in reduced dosage to patients with impaired renal function and hepatic impairment. It should also be used with caution on pregnant and lactating mothers.

Drug Interactions:

Cimetidine has been reported to have interactions with many drugs. Reduction in the dosage of some drugs, such as cyclosporin, lignocaine, nifedipine, phenytoin, suxamethonium, theophylline and warfarin may be needed. The majority of interactions are due to binding of cimetidine to cytochrome P450 in the liver with subsequent inhibition of microsomal oxidative metabolism and increased plasma concentration of drugs metabolised by these enzymes. Other mechanisms of interaction such as altered absorption, competition for renal tubular excretion and changes in hepatic blood flow play only a minor role.

Contraindications:

It is contraindicated in patients hypersensitive to cimetidine.

Dosage and Administration

For oral use

<u>Active peptic ulcer</u>	: 800mg at bedtime for at least 4 weeks. Maintenance: 400mg at bedtime for 6 mths.
<u>NSAID induced lesions</u>	: 400mg twice daily or 800mg at night for at least 6 weeks.
<u>Gastroesophageal reflux disease</u>	: 0.8 - 1.6gm/day for up to 12 weeks.
<u>Zollinger-Ellison syndrome</u>	: 400mg 4 times daily or occasionally more.

Treatment of overdose

No significant effects for doses up to 20g. Treatment: Induction of vomiting and/or gastric lavage with symptomatic and supportive therapy.

Storage conditions	: Keep container tightly closed. Store in a cool, dry place below 30°C. Protect from light. Keep out of reach of children.
Presentation	: 1000's
Manufactured by	: Prime Pharmaceutical Sdn.Bhd.

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Further information can be obtained from your doctor or pharmacist

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